

# Antarctica

The world's coldest continent, Antarctica is also its most remote, meaning it is far from any other land mass. Ice more than 1 mile (1.6 km) thick covers most of it, and temperatures go down to  $-129^{\circ}\text{F}$  ( $-89.2^{\circ}\text{C}$ ), too extreme for many animals. Since it doesn't rain here, Antarctica is considered a desert.

## Location

Antarctica is found at the bottom of the Earth. It is home to the Earth's most southerly point, the South Pole.



## HABITAT KEY



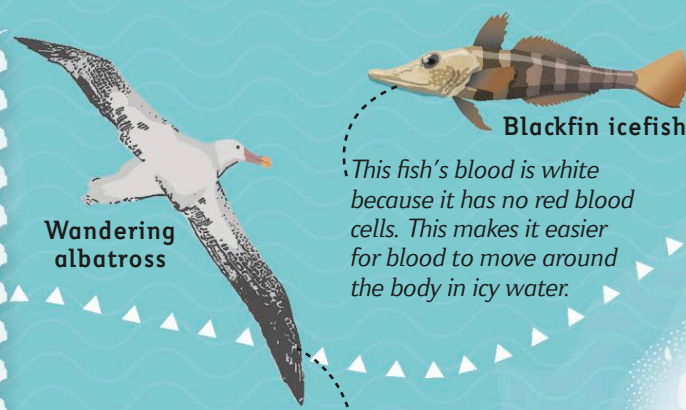
Snow and ice



Mountains

## Southern elephant seal

The southern elephant seal is Earth's largest seal. Males can grow up to 20 ft (6 m) long and weigh 8,501 lb (3,856 kg), but females are much smaller. An inflatable, trunklike nose allows males to make loud roaring calls.



Wandering albatross

Blackfin icefish

This fish's blood is white because it has no red blood cells. This makes it easier for blood to move around the body in icy water.

With the longest wingspan of any bird— $11\frac{1}{2}$  ft (3.5 m)—the wandering albatross can glide for hours at a time.



Weddell seal

Weddell seals can stay underwater for up to 82 minutes while they hunt for icefish.



Chinstrap penguin

These penguins look as if they have a strap around their chin. They are often found on icebergs in the sea around Antarctica.



Patagonian toothfish

Unlike most Antarctic fish, the toothfish has chemicals in its blood that prevent it from freezing.

TO SOUTH AMERICA



Antarctic minke whale

This small whale eats krill by using comblike structures in its mouth called baleen.

TO NEW ZEALAND

Limit of winter pack ice  
Limit of summer pack ice  
SOUTHERN OCEAN

Even though it has enormous jaws and eats other animals, this seal's main food is tiny krill.



Leopard seal

## SCALE

0 250 miles  
0 250 kilometers

South Pole